

Shaping words

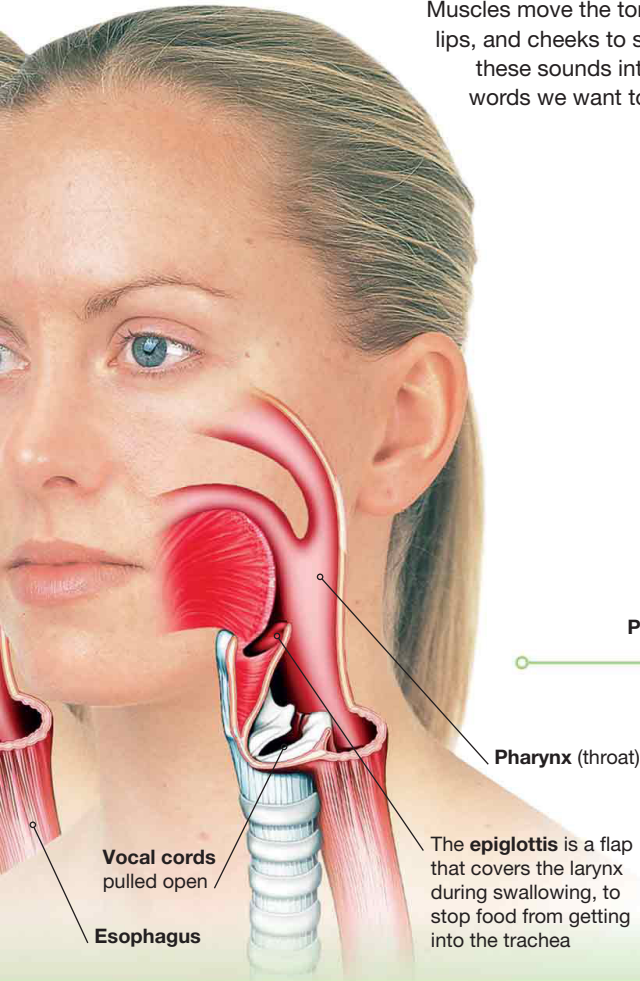
Vibrations of the vocal cords produce humming sounds. Muscles move the tongue, lips, and cheeks to shape these sounds into the words we want to say.



Open mouth forms an “ah” sound



Pursed open lips form an “oo” sound



Vocal cords
pulled open

Esophagus

Pharynx (throat)

The **epiglottis** is a flap that covers the larynx during swallowing, to stop food from getting into the trachea



About 6,900 languages are spoken across the world. The most common are Mandarin Chinese, English, Spanish, Hindi, and Russian.